

THE
WORLD
OF
COLLECTORS



收藏家的世界

The World of Collectors

What is worth keeping? Who decides? And why?



Why Do Humans Collect? 人類為什麼收藏？

Collecting is one of the most human things we do — we've been doing it for 100,000 years!



Passion & Love 熱愛

We collect things we love — stamps, coins, books, art. The joy is in finding and owning something special.



Investment 投資

Rare objects increase in value. A rare stamp bought for £1 in 1840 sold for £2.5 million in 2023!



Knowledge 知識

Scientists collect specimens 標本 to study. Darwin's beetle collection helped him discover evolution!



Preservation 保存

Some collect to save endangered objects — old books, recordings, photographs that might otherwise be lost forever.



Identity & Culture 文化認同

Countries collect their own history. The Palace Museum collects Chinese cultural treasures to preserve Chinese identity.



Pure Joy 純粹快樂

Some people just love it! Studies show that completing a collection gives the same brain feeling as a hug. 🧠💖



Charles Darwin 達爾文

1809 – 1882

Naturalist & Collector
博物學家兼收藏家

 Collected on 5-year voyage on HMS
Beagle



Beetle obsession 甲蟲迷

Darwin loved beetles so much he once put a rare beetle IN HIS MOUTH when his hands were full, just to keep it! He collected over 1,000 species.



Fossil collection 化石收藏

In South America he found giant fossil bones — later identified as giant sloths and armadillos. Evidence of evolution!



The famous finches 雀鳥

He collected 13 different finches from the Galapagos Islands. Their different beaks inspired his theory of natural selection 天擇說.



Plant specimens 植物標本

Over 1,500 plant specimens, carefully pressed and labelled. Many are still in the Natural History Museum London today — 160 years later!



What is a Specimen? 什麼是標本？

A specimen is a sample of a plant, animal, or mineral preserved for study 用於研究的保存樣本



Insect specimens 昆蟲標本

Pinned and labelled on boards. The Natural History Museum London has 80 million insect specimens — the largest collection on Earth!



Plant specimens 植物標本

Pressed flat between paper, dried, and mounted. Some pressed specimens are 400 years old but still show the plant's colour!



Skeletal specimens 骨骼標本

Bones carefully cleaned and assembled. Scientists can tell age, diet, and cause of death from bones alone.



Wet specimens 濕標本

Animals preserved in alcohol or formaldehyde in glass jars. Charles Darwin's specimens from the Beagle voyage are kept this way.



Mineral specimens 礦石標本

Rocks, crystals, and minerals. The Smithsonian has a 45.52 carat Hope Diamond 希望之鑽 — the world's most famous blue diamond!



Egg collections 鳥蛋收藏

Victorian collectors gathered bird eggs. This is now illegal 違法 — too many species were endangered by over-collection.



Famous Collectors of History 歷史上的著名收藏家

CN

Emperor Qianlong 乾隆皇帝

1711–1799

China's greatest imperial collector. He personally collected 86,000 artworks and wrote his name on thousands of them — sometimes ON the painting itself! 蓋章狂！

 **86,000 artworks** 藝術品

RU

Catherine the Great 凱薩琳大帝

1729–1796

Founded the Hermitage Museum in St. Petersburg. She bought entire art collections from European kings — including 225 paintings in one deal from a Berlin merchant!

 **Founded the Hermitage** 艾米塔吉博物館

GB

Sir Hans Sloane 漢斯·斯隆爵士

1660–1753

A doctor who collected 71,000 objects — plants, animals, books, coins, and art from around the world. He left everything to Britain, which became the British Museum!

 **71,000 objects** → **British Museum** 大英博物館

US

J.P. Morgan 摩根

1837–1913

American banker who collected European art obsessively. Spent what would be \$1 billion today on art. His library in New York is still open to the public!

 **\$1 billion in art** 藝術品

A Royal Easter Tradition 皇家復活節傳統

Russia · House of Romanov · Peter Carl Fabergé



Who ordered them?

Russian Tsar Alexander III gave the first egg to his wife in 1885. It became a tradition — every Easter, a new egg!



What's inside?

Each egg opened to reveal a tiny surprise — a miniature palace, a golden hen, a tiny train that actually moves on rails!



How were they made?

Gold, silver, enamel 琺瑯, diamonds, rubies, and pearls. Each took an entire team of jewellers over a year to make.



Where are they now?

Scattered across the world after the Russian Revolution. Some are in the Kremlin 克里姆林宮, some in private collections. A few have vanished!



法貝熱彩蛋

Fabergé Eggs

Russia · 1885–1917



Today's value:

Most valuable: \$33 million USD
Average: \$5-10 million USD each
Only 50 Imperial eggs survive



What Makes Something Worth Collecting? 什麼東西值得收藏？



Rarity 稀有性

The fewer that exist, the more valuable. Only 1 Penny Black stamp 黑便士 exists with a perfect margin — worth £450,000!



Age 年代

Older usually means more valuable — but not always. A signed Banksy print from 2000 is worth more than a 500-year-old anonymous painting.



Provenance 來源

WHO owned it matters hugely. Napoleon's hat sold for €1.9 million in 2023 — it's just a hat, but it was Napoleon's!



Condition 保存狀態

A mint condition 1952 Mickey Mantle baseball card sold for \$12.6 million. A torn one is worth almost nothing.



Sentimental Value 情感價值

To a collector, personal meaning matters. A first edition book signed by your favourite author may be worth more to YOU than any museum piece.



Market Demand 市場需求

Value changes! Pokémon cards 寶可夢卡牌 were thrown away in 1999. A first edition holographic Charizard now sells for \$400,000!



Would YOU Be a Collector? 你會成為收藏家嗎？

1

If you could collect ONE type of thing, what would it be? Why?

如果你能收藏一種東西，你會選什麼？為什麼？

2

What do you already collect — even without realising it?

你現在已經在收藏什麼了嗎（也許你沒意識到）？

3

If you had \$1 million to spend on ONE object, what would you buy?

如果你有100萬美元買一件東西，你買什麼？

4

Should museums return artifacts to their home countries? Why or why not?

博物館應該把文物歸還原來的國家嗎？

**YOUR
COLLECTION
STARTS
HERE**